

LRS: from inquiry to approved quotation

A practical explanation for the company, project team and friends. Human decisions remain visible throughout.

CLIENT

Requests the shipment

Provides cargo details and documents, answers clarification questions, then accepts or revises the company quotation.

AGENT

Owns the commercial decision

Confirms requirements, selects vendors, reviews costs, sets markup and approves communications and commitments.

VENDOR

Prices and delivers the service

Responds with rates, service scope and conditions. Reconfirms availability before the authorized booking handoff.

The system prepares and tracks the work.

LRS stores the case, extracts proposed fields, prepares messages, tracks responses, compares reviewed offers and generates quotation documents. The agent authorizes the important business decisions.

Agreed initial scope

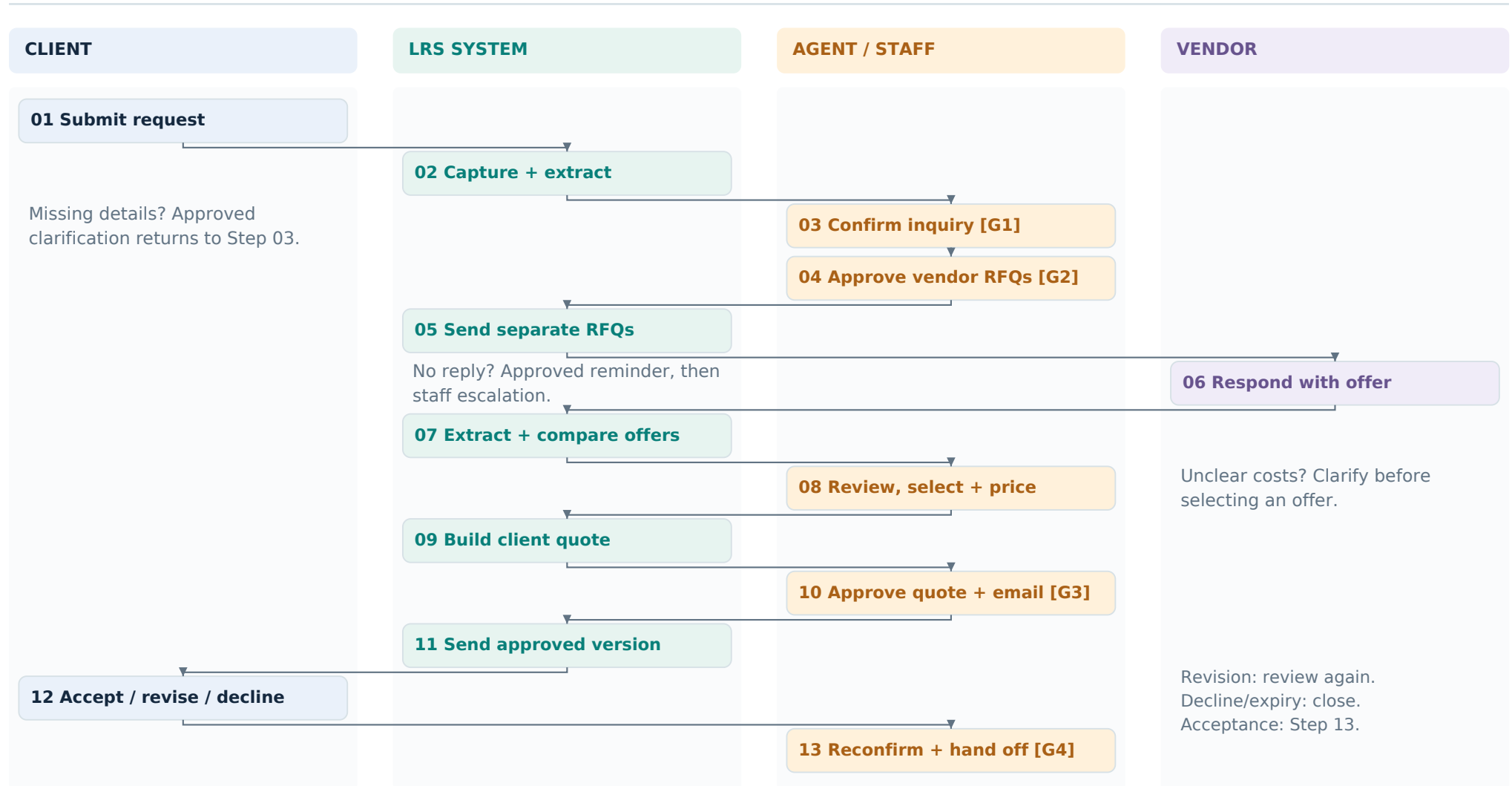
General cargo sea freight: LCL (shared container space) and FCL (full container). The company sells its own quotation with markup. Agents add and choose vendors.

How to read this guide

Pages 2-7 explain the target workflow. Page 8 follows a fictional inquiry. Pages 9-10 show architecture and delivery. Phase 1 is user-reported complete; Phase 2 is next.

Who does what, in order

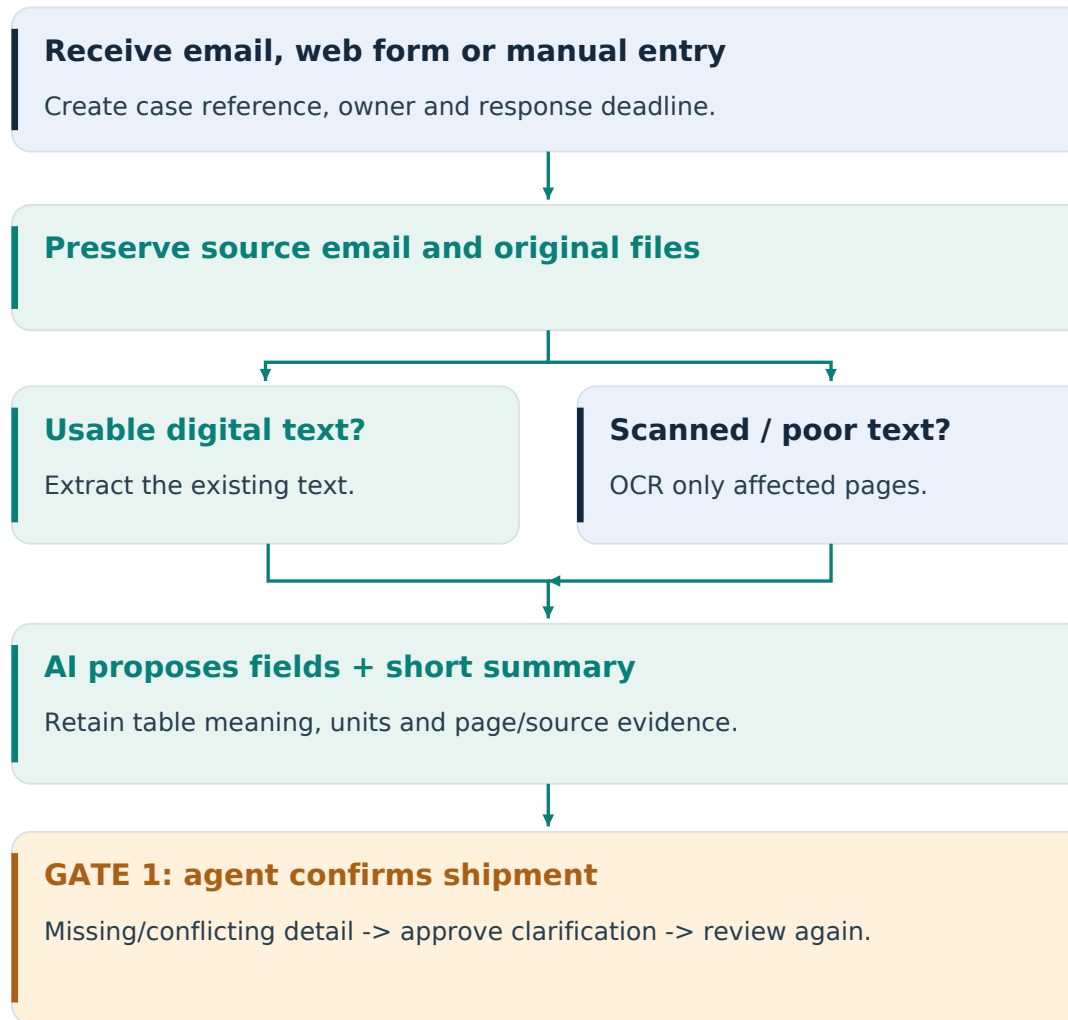
Read numbered steps from top to bottom. Amber nodes mark approvals or commercial decisions.



G1 shipment approval | G2 outreach approval | G3 client quote approval | G4 booking authorization

Capture evidence before confirming requirements

A request can arrive without a quotation. Every extracted field remains a proposal until reviewed.



What may be attached?

Packing list; commercial/pro forma invoice; client RFQ; specifications; photos; or an existing freight quotation.

What must be confirmed?

Contact and route; cargo description; LCL/FCL; quantities, weight and volume/container requirements; cargo-ready date; service boundaries; requested extras.

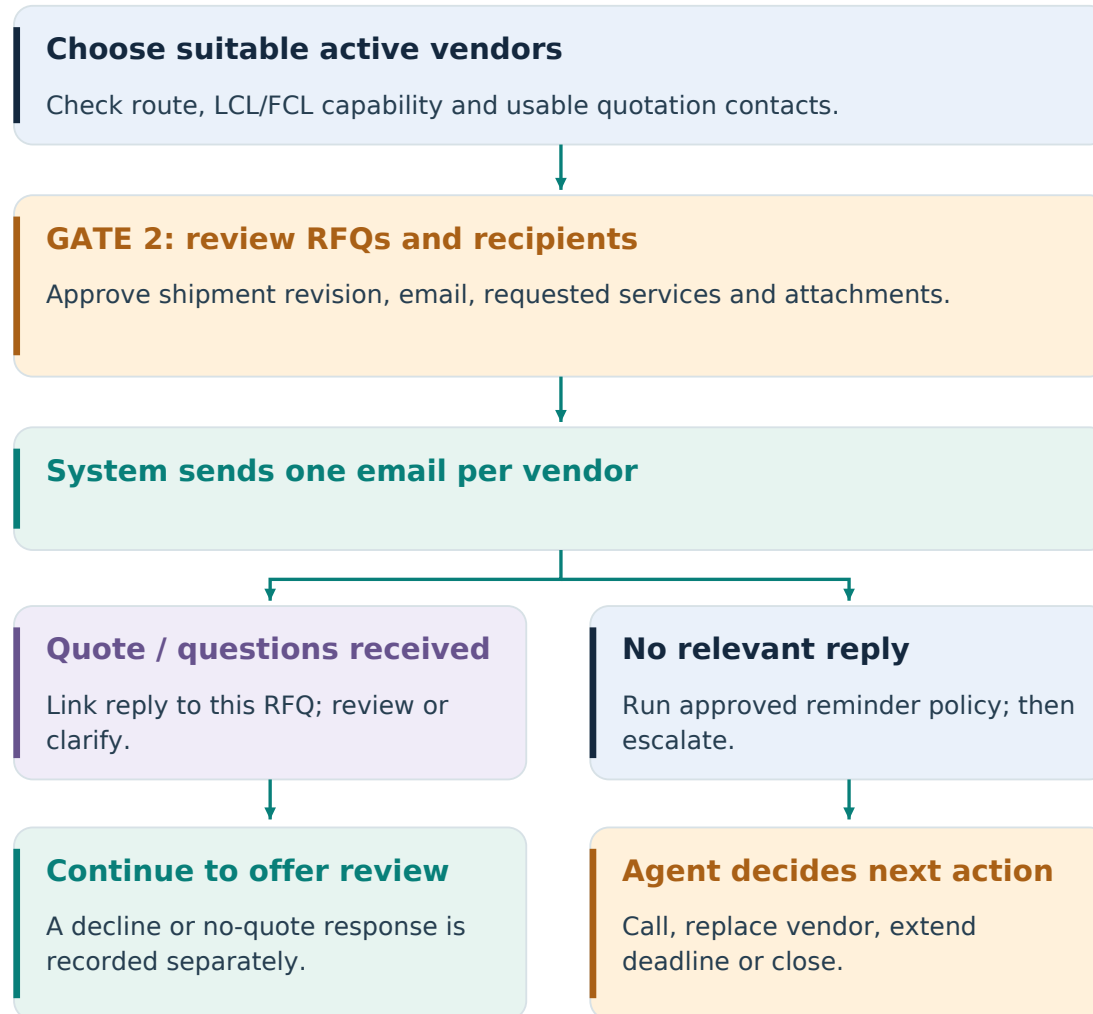
Document processing rule

Use text-first processing. OCR/vision is a fallback for scans or difficult layouts. Keep unknowns blank and show conflicts. Reuse unchanged extraction.

Direct OpenAI PDF input can include both text and page images, increasing model input usage. [1]

The agent chooses who receives the RFQ

Use the company directory and established contacts. Each vendor receives a separate, approved request.



What the RFQ contains

Case reference, confirmed shipment, cargo-ready date, exact requested scope, pricing breakdown request, quote validity and response deadline.

Routine reminder policy

An unchanged, pre-approved template may send automatically. New wording, negotiations or changed requirements require agent approval.

Proposed example - configurable

Reminder 1 after 2 business days; reminder 2 after another 2; then staff escalation. Adjust by urgency, vendor and holidays.

Stop reminders on a relevant reply, decline, cancellation or closed RFQ. Recheck immediately before sending.

Compare complete offers, then set the price

All amounts below are fictional and pre-tax. Comparison requires the same shipment version and service boundaries.

Offer	Freight	Other known costs	Required delivery	Comparable total	Decision state
Vendor A	RM900	RM150	Unknown	RM1,050 + unknown	Clarify first
Vendor B	RM950	RM200	Included	RM1,150	Reviewed / complete
Vendor C	RM1,000	RM300	Included	RM1,300	Reviewed / complete

Unknown cost is never RM0. A lower headline rate is not evidence of a lower complete price.

Review the commercial basis

Units and minimum charges; route/scope; currencies and approved FX basis; inclusions/exclusions; validity and shipment dates; transit estimate; availability and payment terms.

Agent selects Vendor B - example

Reviewed cost base: RM1,150

20% cost markup: RM230

Client selling price: RM1,380

Estimated gross margin: 16.67%

Calculate in application code

Selling price = approved cost base x (1 + markup). Define which charges are marked up or passed through. Keep estimated profit separate from actual job profit. Resolve variable or missing required costs before issuing a firm quote.

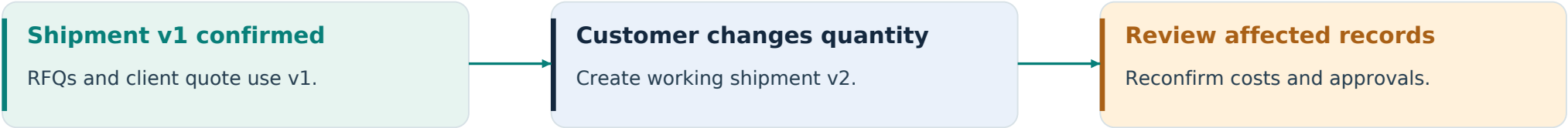
Provider rate conditions and surcharges support explicit validity/inclusion checks. [2, 3]

Approve a specific version, with an audit trail

A material change requires a new review. Previous shipment, RFQ and quotation versions remain available.

Gate	Agent approves	Evidence stored
G1	Shipment requirements	Contact, route, cargo, timing, quantities/units, scope and unresolved gaps.
G2	Vendor outreach	Selected vendors, recipients, message, shipment revision and shared attachments.
G3	Client quotation + email	Selected offer, approved costs, markup, selling terms, PDF revision and recipient.
G4	Booking / job handoff	Client acceptance evidence, vendor rate/capacity, required documents and company payment/credit conditions.

Revision example



Built-in exception handling

Missing details: clarification.

Special cargo: specialist/manual hold.

Unclear or expired offer: vendor reconfirmation.

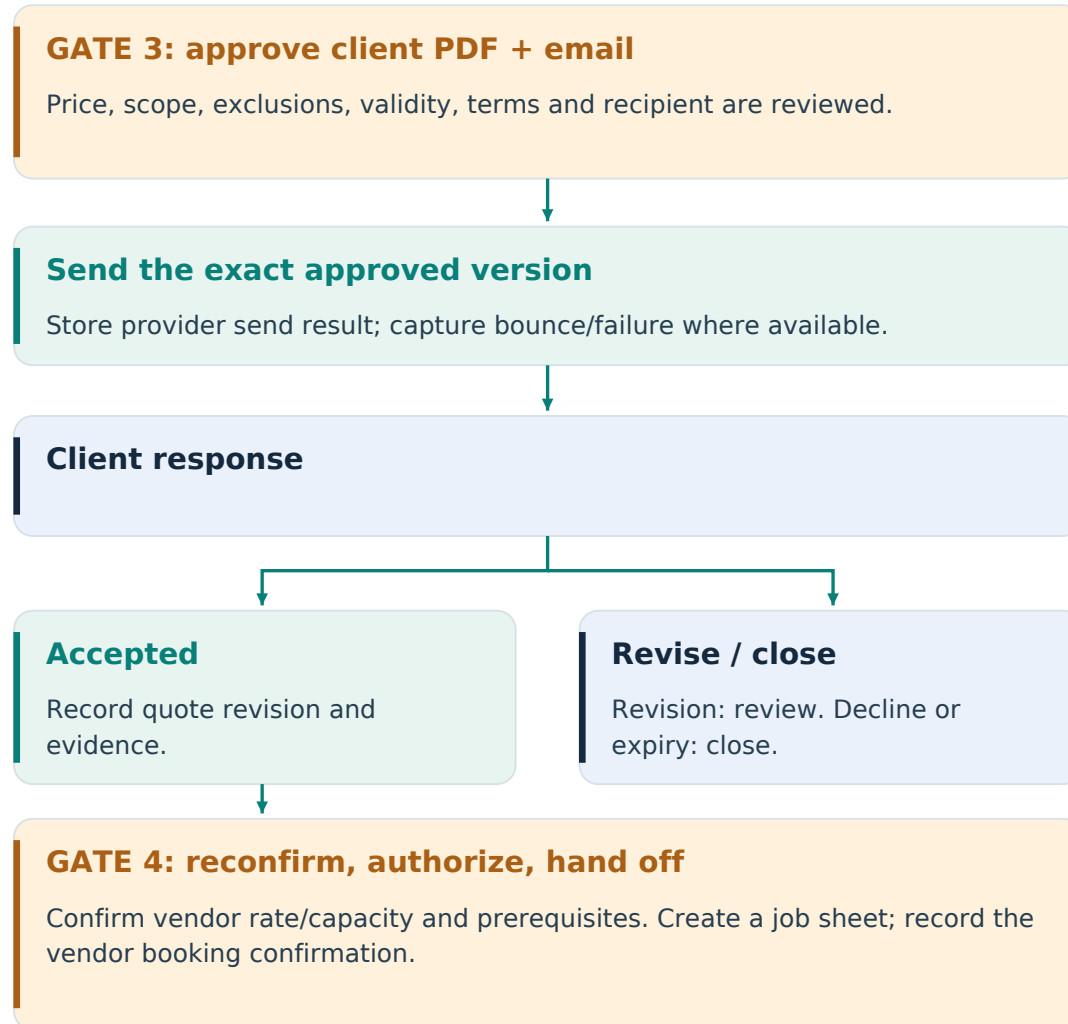
Failed / uncertain send: reconcile before retry.

Unmatched reply: agent review queue.

No suitable vendor: source alternatives or close with reason.

A client acceptance starts another controlled step

Quotation approval, client acceptance and vendor booking confirmation are three different events.



Client quotation includes

Company/client details, quote number and revision, shipment scope, selling price/currency, inclusions/exclusions, estimated transit, validity, payment terms and acceptance instructions.

Keep internal information private

Client documents omit vendor cost, markup, competing offers and internal notes. The company chooses its commercial disclosure policy.

The job sheet carries the agreement

Contacts, shipment version, selected vendor, accepted scope, cost/selling price, documents, deadlines and confirmation references.

Provider submission is not proof of delivery or reading. Client acceptance alone does not confirm vendor capacity.

Follow one inquiry through LRS

12 cartons, 480 kg, Shanghai to Port Klang, general cargo LCL. Cargo-ready date: 12 Oct 2026.

1. Capture the request

Email and packing list arrive. Create the case, owner and deadline. Dimensions are missing.

2. Clarify the gap

Agent approves consolidated questions. Client provides 2.4 m3 total volume and confirms the requested delivery scope.

3. Confirm the shipment

Agent reviews source evidence and confirms shipment v1. It becomes Ready for sourcing.

4. Send approved RFQs

Agent selects Vendors A, B and C from the directory. Separate RFQs are reviewed and sent.

5. Review the responses

A has an unknown required charge. B offers a reviewed RM1,150 cost base. C offers RM1,300.

6. Set the client price

Agent chooses B and applies 20% markup: RM1,380. System creates the client quotation PDF.

7. Approve and obtain acceptance

Agent approves the exact PDF/email. Client accepts that quotation revision; evidence is retained.

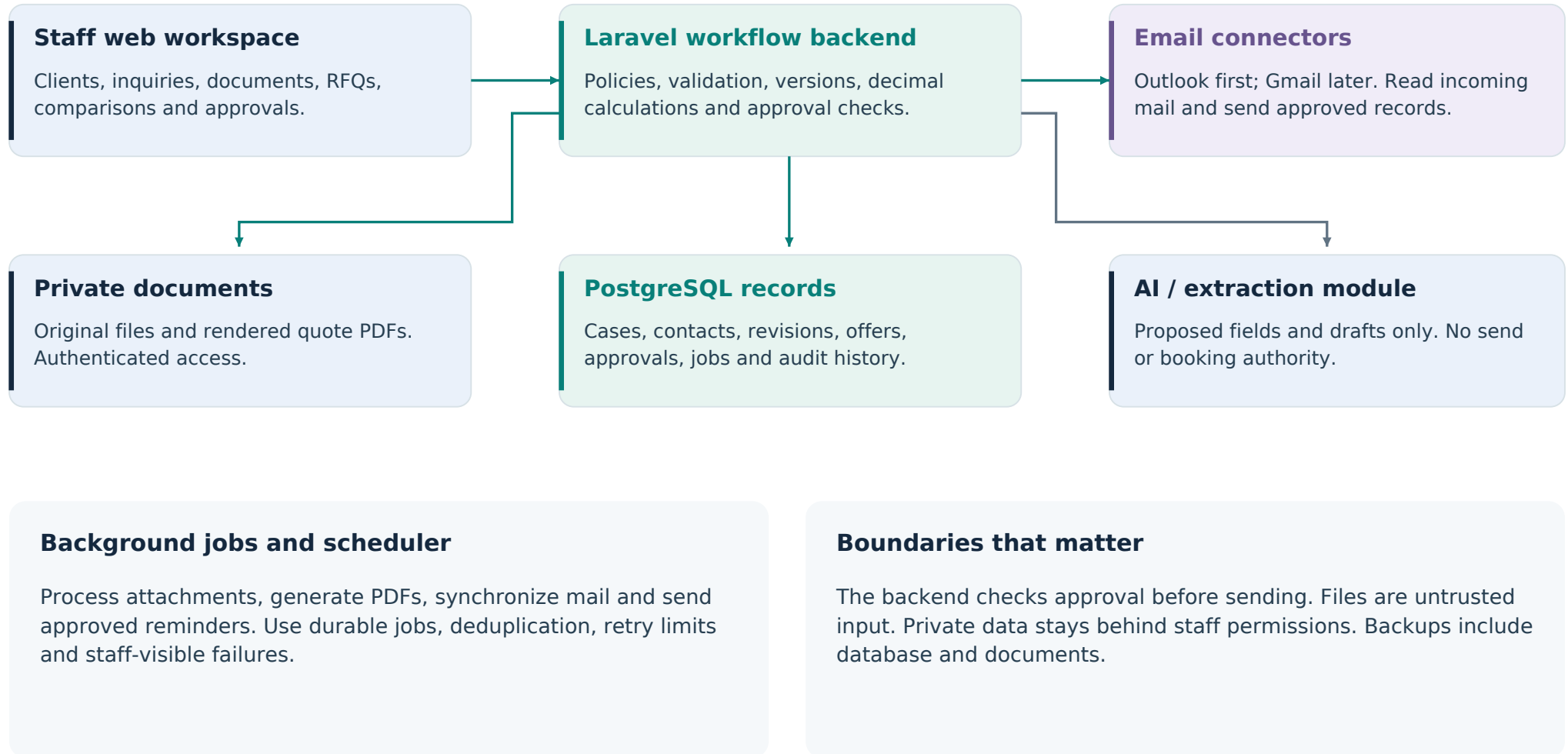
8. Reconfirm and hand off

Vendor confirms rate/capacity. Agent checks prerequisites and authorizes the booking/job handoff.

If the quantity changes at any point, preserve v1, create v2 and recheck affected costs and approvals.

One Laravel application owns the workflow

Blade + Tailwind for staff screens; PostgreSQL for records; replaceable email and AI integrations.



Technical design baseline, not a claim that these integrations or future modules have already been implemented.

Build the workflow in 11 usable phases

Each phase includes its screens, validation, permissions and verification. This is the agreed build order.

Phase	Delivered capability	Milestone / status
1	Staff access, vendor directory and visual system	Reported complete
2	Clients, manual inquiries, private documents and human review	Next phase
3	Text extraction, OCR fallback, AI proposals and source review	Planned
4	Vendor selection, RFQ drafts and outreach approvals	Planned
5	Outlook intake/sending, reply matching and recovery	Planned
6	Reviewed vendor quotations and comparable-cost selection	Planned
7	Markup, client quotation PDFs, approval and sending	Core quote flow
8	Approved follow-ups, cancellation and escalation	Planned
9	Gmail connector (9A) and customer web form (9B)	Planned
10	Client outcome, vendor reconfirmation and booking handoff	Planned
11	Reports, full-flow pilot, production and backup checks	Release checks

Terms: RFQ = request for quotation. LCL = shared container space. FCL = full container. OCR = text recognition from scans. Markup is a percentage of cost; margin is a percentage of selling price.

Source notes and decisions still to confirm

[1] [OpenAI: PDF file-input processing](#)

[2] [Maersk: quote validity and rate-sheet conditions](#)

[3] [Hapag-Lloyd: trade surcharges](#)

Follow-up timings are proposed settings. Validate company routes, vendor relationships, quotation terms, billing/claims responsibility, tax treatment, retention and mailbox permissions before the pilot.